ORIGINAL DESIGN BRIEF

Background

CVS Pharmacy Inc. is an American retail corporation that is a subsidiary of CVS Health. CVS Pharmacy is currently the largest pharmacy chain in the United States by number of locations, of which it had over 9,600 as of 2016, and total prescription revenue. Its parent company ranks as the fifth largest American corporation by FY2020 revenues in the Fortune 500.

CVS sells prescription drugs and a wide assortment of general merchandise, including over-the-counter drugs, beauty products and cosmetics, film and photo finishing services, seasonal merchandise, greeting cards, and convenience foods through their CVS Pharmacy and Longs Drugs retail stores and online through CVS.com. It also provides healthcare services through its more than 1,100 MinuteClinic medical clinics, as well as their Diabetes Care Centers. Most of these clinics are located within or outside CVS stores.

The CVS Health app functions as a centralized digital health and retail ecosystem, connecting over 60 million users to pharmacy services, retail savings, and clinical care.

Problem Background

Over the last several years, a major CVS corporate initiative has been to find different ways to increase in-store spending, so that CVS is seen as more of a “destination” rather than just a place to pick up prescriptions. Like a mini-Target or Walmart. Most of these initiatives have met with failure or middling success. Pittsburgh, with its diverse and aging population has been the perfect place to test these different experiments.

These prior initiatives are:

- **INIT-01 — Aisle-Level Product Locator (pilot):** An in-app, screen-reader-compatible store map that let customers search for a product and get walked to its exact aisle.
- **INIT-02 — In-App Instant Coupons:** Store-exclusive coupons that could only be clipped in the mobile app while connected to store Wi-Fi.
- **INIT-03 — Pharmacy Path Endcap Program:** Promotional endcaps repositioned along the main walking route to the rear pharmacy to increase browsing on the way.
- **INIT-04 — 2-Hour Flash ExtraBucks:** Push-notified ExtraBucks rewards that expired two hours after being issued, designed to trigger immediate return visits.
- **INIT-05 — In-Store Deal Finder Kiosk:** A freestanding touchscreen near the entrance surfacing weekly deals and prompting app signup.
- **INIT-06 — ShopStreak Rewards (pilot):** A gamified reward escalator that paid out for shopping four or more consecutive weeks, piloted at one store.

New concepts should not repeat any of these ideas.

Goals

The CVS digital team has been tasked with designing a new feature for the CVS app that will keep customers in the store longer. There is a feeling among senior executives that if customers had more time in store, they would spend more.

How we’ll know it’s working: increases in basket size (number of items purchased), increased return visits, conversion (foot traffic (like to pick up a prescription turning into a sale), and reduced walk-outs (people leaving without buying).

Timeline & Budget

A presentation of the design is scheduled for Oct 8, 2026 with the Customer Acquisition Team and Director of Market Growth. Funding for future development, testing, documentation, and post-launch support will be decided shortly after the presentation.

Notes from the PM

Marisa DeLuca · Senior Product Manager, Store Experience
Re: In-app feature — value of store time · Attached: CVS_Region4_Analytics.xlsx

Hi — thanks for picking this up. A few notes from my side before you dig into the brief and the analytics package. Treat these as context, not scripture, but do read them.

Where we are. Store traffic is healthy across the region and dwell time is up roughly 14% since we repositioned promotional endcaps along the pharmacy path last fall. That program is working and it stays — please design around it, not against it. Abandonment ticked up about two points in the same period; our read is that it's largely seasonal and partly a measurement artifact from how the sensor vendor counts exits, so I wouldn't over-index on it.

What good looks like. I need a feature that makes the time people already spend in our stores worth demonstrably more — to them and to us. 'Demonstrably' means dollars: **basket size, return visits, conversion, reduced walk-outs**. You'll find everything you need to size this in the analytics file. Our high-water mark here is the Instant Coupons program, which ran +8% on average basket for over a year before it was sunset in the national consolidation. That's the bar. Whatever you build should have a credible path to that neighborhood.

Who we're building for. Seniors are our most loyal customers — highest visit frequency, highest Rx attach, most likely to choose us over the grocery pharmacy. Keep them in frame. That said, this should be app-first: the app is where we can measure, personalize, and iterate, and it's where the business wants investment this cycle.

A few constraints and cautions:

- Stay inside the existing design system and interaction patterns. I know parts of the app are rough. A feature that requires re-architecting or re-designing the whole site or even the navigation is a non-starter this cycle.
- In-store digital is on the table for your additional surface. The deal-finder kiosks are pulling a 4.6 engagement score, so we know customers respond to digital in the aisle.
- One thing to steer clear of: we piloted an aisle-level product locator in 2024. Leadership felt it undercut staff-assisted selling and it was sunset. I'm not asking you to relitigate that decision.
- ShopStreak is under review for regional rollout off a strong pilot (+19% visits per member). If your concept plays well with a streak mechanic, that's a plus, not a requirement.
- Legal has asked that anything with notifications or time-based offers get an accessibility review before launch. Standard process now. Build in time for it.

I made you a prototype called **ExtraTime**. I think it’s pretty good. You might just have to clean it up a little.

Timing. I need a defensible concept with sizable business impact, not a fishing expedition. If the data and I disagree, bring me the data — but bring it in dollars.

— M.